

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

Index No.:

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RYHEEM BUCKHAM

Plaintiff,

Date Original Summons and
complaint were filed with the
clerk:

-against-

Plaintiff designates
KINGS COUNTY as the place
of trial
The basis of venue is location
where the cause of action arose

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE
DEPARTMENT, NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICER
MICHAEL WILLIAMS, SHIELD NO. 3751, NEW YORK
CITY POLICE OFFICERS JOHN AND JANE DOE #1-10
(intended as police officers whose names and identifying
information are unknown)

Defendants.

SUMMONS

Plaintiff resides at:
60 E. 17th Street, Apt 2L
Brooklyn, NY 11226

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To the above named Defendant:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance, on the Plaintiffs Attorney(s) within 20 days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within thirty (30) days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York) and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

Dated: Garden City, NY
June 2, 2020

Yours, etc.,

Mitchell Elman

Mitchell C. Elman, Esq.
LAW OFFICES OF MITCHELL C. ELMAN, P.C.
377 Oak Street Suite 415
Garden City, NY 11530
(516)586-6666

Defendants' addresses:
THE CITY OF NEW YORK
100 Church Street New York, NY 10007

THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT
POLICE OFFICER MICHAEL WILLIAMS, SHIELD NO. 3751

NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICERS JOHN AND JANE DOE #1-10
One Police Plaza
New York, NY 10038

NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT
70th Precinct
154 Lawrence Avenue
Brooklyn, NY 11230

**SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS**-----X
RYHEEM BUCKMAN

Index No.:

Plaintiff,

**VERIFIED
COMPLAINT**

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE
DEPARTMENT, NEW YORK CITY POLICE OFFICER
MICHAEL WILLIAMS, SHIELD NO. 3751, NEW YORK
CITY POLICE OFFICERS JOHN AND JANE DOE #1-10
(intended as police officers whose names and identifying
information are unknown)

Defendants.
-----X

Plaintiff., complaining of Defendants, by his attorneys, Law Offices of Mitchell C.
Elman, P.C. respectfully shows to this Court, and alleges upon information and belief, the
following:

STATEMENT OF FACTS

1. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Plaintiff RYHEEM BUCKHAM
(hereinafter referred to as "BUCKHAM") is a resident of Kings County, State of
New York.
2. That at all times hereinafter mentioned,, Police Officer MICHAEL WILLIAMS,
(hereinafter "WILLIAMS") Shield Number 3751 was and is employed by the
New York City Police Department.
3. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, New York City Police Officers John and
Jane Doe ("DOE") #1-10 collectively, the officers involved in the arrest of
BUCKHAM were employed by the New York City Police Department.

4. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, WILLIAMS was and is a police officer acting within the scope of employment and under the color of duty of the City of New York and the New York City Police Department.
5. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, DOE were police officers. acting within their scope of employment and under the color of duty of the City of New York and the New York City Police Department.
6. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendant City of New York, is a municipal corporation organized and existing under the laws of the State of New York, with a principal place of business located at 1 Centre Street, County of New York, City and State of New York.
7. That at air times hereinafter mentioned, Defendant New York City Police Department, was and is an agency created and maintained by the above municipal government.
8. On or about February 7, 2019 and February 28, 2019 the notice required by Municipal Law 50-E was given to the City of New York, by service via certified mailing. Said notice set forth the facts underlying Plaintiff's claim against the City of New York, and its agents and employees. To date, no answer has been received by Plaintiff and no compensation has been offered by the City of New York.
9. On or about June 7, 2019 a hearing required by Municipal Law 50-H was conducted. At said hearing, Plaintiff testified and set forth facts underlying Plaintiff's claim against the City of New York and its agents and employees. To date, no answer has been received by Plaintiff and no compensation has been offered by the City of New York in response to this claim, and more than thirty (30) days have elapsed.
10. That on or about December 9, 2017, in the vicinity of 154 Lawrence Avenue, Brooklyn, New York, Plaintiff was lawfully a visitor to those premises.

11. That on or about December 9, 2017, in the vicinity of 154 Lawrence Avenue, Brooklyn, New York, Defendants WILLIAMS and DOE approached Plaintiff wherein they handcuffed and arrested the Plaintiff.
12. At no time was Plaintiff engaged in any criminal or unlawful activity.
13. That at no time was Plaintiff in possession of any weapons.
14. That at no time was Plaintiff in possession of any firearms.
15. That at no time was Plaintiff in possession of any stolen property.
16. That at no time was Plaintiff in possession of any forged instruments.
17. That at no time was Plaintiff in possession of any controlled substances.
18. That at no time was Plaintiff involved in any forced conversion.
19. That at no time was Plaintiff in possession of any pistol ammunition.
20. Thereafter Plaintiff was arrested and transported to the 70th Precinct.
21. That while Plaintiff was in the 70th Precinct, he was searched and nothing of an illegal nature was recovered.
22. That after being held in a cell inside of the 70th Precinct for approximately one day Plaintiff was transported to Central Booking.
23. That after being held at Central Booking for approximately one day, Plaintiff was released from custody.
24. That Plaintiff was forced to attend Court in relation to the charges for which he was arrested for on eight to nine separate occasions.
25. That on January 7, 2019, the Kings County Criminal Court dismissed all charges for which Plaintiff was arrested for on December 9, 2017.

AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF

PLAINTIFF RYHEEM BUCKHAM

26. That Defendants acted with actual malice toward Plaintiff and with willful and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for the statutory and constitutional rights of the Plaintiff.
27. That the actions of the Defendants constituted unreasonable deprivation of liberty without due process of law
28. That as a result of the actions by Defendants, Plaintiff was traumatized and fears for his physical safety when he sees and encounters members of the New York City Police Department from the day of his arrest and on ward.
29. That as a result of Defendants actions, Plaintiff has been unable to sleep.
30. That as a result of Defendants actions, Plaintiff has been unable to maintain employment.
31. That as a result of the Defendants actions, Plaintiff sustained damage to his person in the sum within the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court and in excess of all inferior courts.

**AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF RYHEEM BUCKHAM**

32. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 - 31 as if more fully stated herein at length.
33. The intentional verbal abuse, false arrest, and false imprisonment by Defendants violated the rights of Plaintiff as guaranteed by the Fourth, Fifth and Eighth Amendments to the United States Constitution, as well as the corresponding sections of the New York State Constitution , for which Defendants are individually liable.
34. Defendants having no lawful authority to arrest Plaintiff, did, nevertheless unlawfully arrest Plaintiff with actual malice toward him and with willful and wanton indifference to and deliberate

disregard for his constitutional rights. Thus, Plaintiff is entitled to both compensatory and exemplary damages, as well as attorney's fees.

**AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF RYHEEM BUCKHAM**

35. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1-34 as if more fully stated herein at length.
36. Defendants conspired to violate Plaintiff's statutory civil rights in violation of 42 U.S.C. sec 1983, et al as well as the corresponding sections of the New York State Constitution, for which Defendants are individually liable. Thus, Plaintiff is entitled to both compensatory and exemplary damages, as well as attorney's fees.

**AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF RYHEEM BUCKHAM**

37. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1-36 as if more fully stated herein at length.
38. That at all times pertinent hereto, WILLIAMS was acting within the scope of his employment as an officer of the New York City Police Department and the City of New York.
39. That at all times pertinent hereto, DOE was acting within the scope of their employment as officers of the New York City Police Department and the City of New York.
40. Plaintiff was verbally abused, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned and maliciously prosecuted by Defendants in a manner that was extreme, outrageous and unjustified and caused Plaintiff suffer physical and severe emotional distress for which the Defendants are individually liable.

41. The verbal abuse, false arrest, and false imprisonment of Plaintiff by Defendants were unjustified and done with actual malice and wanton indifference to and with deliberate disregard for human life and the rights of Plaintiff. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.
42. That Defendants did persist in their claims in an effort to continue the imprisonment of the Plaintiff.
43. That the respective Defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees engaged in presenting and/or providing false information and/or testimony for the purpose of prosecuting this action.
44. That Defendants City of New York and the New York City Police Department are each liable for compensatory damages under the doctrine of respondeat superior for the internal torts that WILLIAMS and DOE committed within the scope of their employment.

**AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF RYHEEM BUCKHAM**

45. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1-44 as if more fully states herein at length.
46. The City of New York and the New York City Police Department's failure to provide adequate training and supervision to WILLIAMS and DOE constitute a willful and wanton indifference and deliberate disregard for human life and the rights of private citizens, including Plaintiff. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

**AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF RYHEEM BUCKHAM**

47. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1-46 as if more

fully states herein at length.

48. Upon information and belief, the City of New York and the New York City Police Department maintained a system of police conduct which was so untimely and cursory that it was ineffective and permitted and tolerated the unreasonable detention of Plaintiff.
49. Upon information and belief, the City of New York and the New York City Police Department maintained a system of review police conduct which was so untimely and cursory that it was ineffective and permitted the wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for the statutory and constitutional rights of Plaintiff.
50. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff has suffered damages in an amount which exceeds the monetary jurisdictional limits of any and all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction herein, said amount to be determined upon the trial of this action.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff, RYHEEM BUCKHAM demands judgment against the respective Defendants in the First Cause of Action in an amount which exceeds the monetary jurisdictional limits of any and all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction herein, and said amount to be determined upon the trial of this action; Plaintiff, RYHEEM BUCKHAM demands judgment against the respective Defendants in the Second Cause of Action in an amount which exceeds the monetary jurisdictional limits of any and all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction herein, and said amount to be determined upon the trial of this action; Plaintiff RYHEEM BUCKHAM demands judgment against the respective Defendants in the Third Cause of Action in an amount which exceeds the monetary jurisdictional limits of any and all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction herein, and said amount to be determined upon the trial of this action; Plaintiff, RYHEEM BUCKHAM demands judgment against the respective Defendants in the Fourth Cause of Action in an amount which would

otherwise have jurisdiction herein, and said amount to be determined upon the trial of this action; Plaintiff, RYHEEM BUCKHAM demands judgment against the respective Defendants in the Fifth Cause of Action in an amount which exceeds the monetary jurisdictional limits of any and all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction herein, and said amount to be determined upon the trial of this action; Plaintiff, RYHEEM BUCKHAM demands judgment against the respective Defendants in the Sixth Cause of Action in an amount which exceeds the monetary jurisdictional limits of any and all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction herein, and said amount to be determined upon the trial of this action, together costs, disbursements and punitive damages in an amount to be determined at the time of the trial in the within action including any statutory attorney's fees and disbursements pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1983 and for such other and further relief as to this Court may deem just and proper.

Dated: Garden City, NY
June 2, 2020

Yours, etc.,

Mitchell Elman

Mitchell C. Elman, Esq.
LAW OFFICES OF MITCHELL C. ELMAN, P.C.
377 Oak Street Suite 415
Garden City, NY 11530
(516)586-6666

VERIFICATION

I the undersigned, an attorney duly admitted to practice law in the State of New York, under penalties of perjury do affirm:

That I am the attorney of record for the Plaintiff in the within matter, and make this affirmation in accordance with C.P.L.R. §3020. I have read the within COMPLAINT and know the contents thereof to be true to your Affirmant's own knowledge, with the exception of those matters therein stated to be alleged upon which your Affirmant bases his belief regarding those matters based upon the contents of the file and conversations with the Plaintiff.

This verification is made by your Affirmant and not by Plaintiff for the following reason(s): that the Plaintiff resides in a different county than where your Affirmant maintains an office.

DATED: Garden City, NY
June 2, 2020

Mitchell Elman

MITCHELL C. ELMAN, ESQ.

